Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) Matrix by Task

Purpose

This document defines the minimum personal protective equipment required for common tasks at Riverbend Packaging. PPE is the last line of defense after engineering and administrative controls. It does not replace lockout/tagout, guarding, or ventilation. The matrix sets minimums; a task hazard assessment may require more.

General Floor Requirements

Anyone entering the production floor must wear safety glasses with side shields, steel- or composite-toe footwear, and hearing protection in posted areas above 85 dBA. Long hair must be tied back and loose jewelry removed near rotating equipment. Visitors follow the same rules and must be escorted.

PPE Matrix

Task	Eyes/Face	Hands	Body	Respiratory	Hearing
General line operation	Safety glasses	None required	Standard uniform	None	Plugs in posted areas
Conveyor jam clearing (after LOTO)	Safety glasses	Cut-resistant gloves (A4)	Standard uniform	None	Plugs
Capper changeover (CX-4)	Safety glasses	Cut-resistant gloves (A4)	Standard uniform	None	Plugs
Sanitizer changeover / CIP	Splash goggles and face shield	Nitrile gloves, 15 mil minimum	Chemical apron	None if ventilated	Plugs
Chemical spill response (small)	Splash goggles	Nitrile gloves, 15 mil	Chemical apron, boot covers	Half-mask with organic vapor cartridge if odor present	None
RP-200 pump seal replacement	Splash goggles	Nitrile over cut-resistant liner	Apron	None	Plugs
Hydraulic press maintenance	Safety glasses	Leather work gloves	Long sleeves	None	Muffs
Welding or hot work	Welding helmet shade 10	Welding gloves	FR jacket	Fume respirator	Plugs

NOTE: Cut-resistant gloves must not be worn near exposed rotating shafts, rollers, or nip points. Remove gloves if the task places hands near a pinch hazard that could entangle fabric.

Eye and Face Protection

Safety glasses must meet ANSI Z87.1. Splash goggles are required whenever liquid could reach the eyes, including sanitizer dilution, cleaning solutions, and hydraulic fluid work. Use a face shield over goggles when pouring concentrate or when pressurized lines are opened. Prescription glasses do not substitute for safety eyewear unless rated.

Hand Protection

Selecting the wrong glove is a common cause of injury.

1. Match the glove to the hazard: cut, chemical, heat, or abrasion.
2. Inspect gloves for tears or pinholes before every use.
3. Replace nitrile gloves after any splash or when swollen or sticky.
4. Wash hands after removing gloves.

Chemical glove selection follows the Safety Data Sheet for the product. Peracetic acid sanitizer requires gloves rated for oxidizers; thin disposable gloves are not acceptable for concentrate handling.

Respiratory Protection

Respirators are required only when engineering controls cannot hold exposure below limits. Wearers must be medically cleared, fit-tested annually, and clean-shaven where the seal contacts the face. Cartridges are replaced at the end of each shift of use or when odor is noticed.

Hearing Protection

Areas marked with blue signage exceed 85 dBA. The capper and hydraulic press bay regularly exceed 90 dBA. Foam plugs must be rolled and inserted deeply; muffs are required in the press bay. Dual protection (plugs plus muffs) is required if exposure exceeds 100 dBA.

Inspection, Care, and Replacement

Employees inspect PPE before each use. Damaged, contaminated beyond cleaning, or expired items are removed from service and replaced at no cost through the supply cage. Face shields and goggles are cleaned with mild soap after each chemical task. Footwear is replaced when the toe cap is exposed or soles are worn.

Training

Employees receive PPE training at hire and when tasks change. Training covers when PPE is required, what is necessary, how to put on and remove it, its limitations, and proper care and disposal. Supervisors verify compliance during daily walk-throughs and document corrections.